

7 First Foods Your Ancestors Fed Their Babies

A FREE GUIDE FROM NOURISHED FROM BIRTH

Before pouches, before rice cereal, before commercial baby food — there was real food. Slow-cooked, mineral-rich, passed from the family pot to the smallest member without a second thought. These are the 7 foods that traditional cultures around the world have fed their babies for thousands of years. They're still the best foods you can offer today.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Introduce one new food at a time. Wait 3-5 days before adding another. All foods in this guide are appropriate from 6 months+ unless otherwise noted. Always consult your pediatrician before starting solids.

01 **Egg Yolk** THE ORIGINAL BRAIN FOOD

6 MONTHS+

Rich in choline, healthy fats, and fat-soluble vitamins — egg yolk is one of the most nutrient-dense first foods you can offer. Soft boil for 4 minutes, cut in half, and scoop out the yolk with a spoon. Serve as is or mash with avocado, banana, or applesauce. Start with the yolk only — introduce whites separately as they are a more common allergen. Always use the freshest pasture-raised eggs you can find from a trusted local farm.

Tip: Quality matters: pasture-raised eggs have significantly more choline and Vitamin D than conventional.

02 Meat Stock

LIQUID GOLD FOR TINY GUTS

6 MONTHS+

Not bone broth — meat stock. Simmered for 2-4 hours rather than 24+, meat stock is gentler on a baby's immature digestive system while still being rich in gelatin, collagen, and minerals. Every traditional culture made some version of this. Iranian grandmothers called it the first food after mother's milk — and they were right. Offer warm in a sippy cup or mix into purees to add nutrients and depth of flavor.

Tip: Use meat stock (short simmer) for babies under 12 months. Bone broth (long simmer) can be introduced after 12 months.

03 Liver

THE ANCESTRAL SUPERFOOD

6 MONTHS+

Gram for gram, liver is the most nutrient-dense food on the planet — rich in iron, B12, folate, and Vitamin A. Traditional cultures across Africa, Asia, the Middle East, and the Americas all fed liver to their babies. Beef liver is the most widely available, chicken liver has the mildest taste and softest texture, and lamb liver connects to the rich culinary tradition of the Middle East. Start with small amounts — 1 to 2 teaspoons, 1 to 2 times per week — due to its high Vitamin A content.

Tip: Blend into meat purees or mix with sweet potato. Choose organic, pasture-raised liver when possible.

04 Slow-Cooked Meat

IRON THE WAY NATURE INTENDED

6 MONTHS+

Slow-cooked lamb, beef, or chicken — fall-apart tender, rich in heme iron that is far more absorbable than plant-based sources. In Iran, lamb shank stew was a staple long before baby food existed. Shred finely and add a spoonful of butter or tallow for younger babies, offer soft chunks as they grow. The broth is just as valuable as the meat — always serve both together. Cook low and slow until the meat falls apart completely.

Tip: Add butter or tallow when serving — the fat helps absorb the fat-soluble vitamins in the meat.

05 Wild-Caught Fish

BRAIN-BUILDING OMEGA-3S FROM THE SEA

6 MONTHS+

Coastal and island cultures around the world have fed fish to babies as one of their first foods. Rich in DHA, omega-3 fatty acids, and easily digestible protein. Choose low-mercury, wild-caught fish — salmon, sardines, cod, or trout — and always cook fully before serving. Mash with a fork for younger babies, offer soft flakes as they develop. Fish is a common allergen so introduce carefully, start with a small amount, and watch for any reactions before offering more.

Tip: Avoid high-mercury fish: shark, swordfish, king mackerel, and tilefish. Stick to salmon, sardines, and cod.

06 Fish Roe

THE SACRED FERTILITY AND BABY FOOD

8 MONTHS+

Weston A. Price documented fish roe as one of the most prized foods across traditional cultures — from the Inuit to Native Americans to Pacific Islanders. Rich in DHA, omega-3 fatty acids, fat-soluble vitamins, and zinc. A tiny amount goes a long way. Introduce cautiously as it can be higher in sodium — rinse well before serving and offer a very small amount to start. Source from wild-caught, quality suppliers. Introduce only after other fish has been well tolerated.

Tip: Introduce after other fish is already tolerated. A tiny pinch is enough — it is nutrient-dense.

07 Fermented Dairy

LIVING FOOD FOR A LIVING GUT

6 MONTHS+

Yogurt and kefir have been fermented and fed to babies across the Middle East, Central Asia, and beyond for thousands of years. The fermentation process breaks down lactose and makes dairy far easier to digest than regular milk. Rich in probiotics that seed your baby's gut microbiome from the very first bites. Offer as a food alongside other meals — not as a milk replacement. Always choose full fat, plain, with no added sugar.

Tip: Cow's milk as a main drink should wait until 12 months. Yogurt and kefir as foods are fine from 6 months.

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